

Harborline Logistics

Prepared for Alex Rivera | 2026-09-29 | New-logo discovery call

Call-day snapshot

The few things most likely to change how this call goes.

- 1 Leadership said on the **Q2 call** that late-delivery penalties are their biggest margin drag. Lead with dispatch accuracy, not cost savings.
- 2 Dana Whitfield inherited a **two-region consolidation** in July. Expect her to care about one standard process over feature depth.
- 3 Likely blocker: **IT security review** (a new CISO was hired in August). Ask early who signs off on data access.
- 4 Competitor **FleetWise** is probably the incumbent shortlist. Their weak spot is multi-depot balancing.

COMPANY	Harborline Logistics
WEBSITE	harborline-logistics.example
CONTACT	Dana Whitfield, VP of Operations
DEAL TYPE	New-logo discovery call
OUR SOLUTION	RouteIQ dispatch optimization platform (fictional)
RESEARCH DATE	2026-09-29

Route status

01 Account brief COMPLETE	02 Pain from earnings calls COMPLETE	03 Contact's role PARTIAL	04 Discovery questions COMPLETE	05 Specific opener COMPLETE
06 Buying committee PARTIAL	07 Likely objections COMPLETE	08 Competitor landscape PARTIAL	09 Battle card PARTIAL	10 Follow-up plan COMPLETE

A

Know the account

Earn your first five minutes with context.

01 One-page account brief

What they do, who they serve, what changed lately.

Harborline is a regional third-party logistics provider running about 40 depots across the U.S. Southeast and Midwest, moving mid-market retail and building-products freight. Revenue is reported near \$1.8B with a private-equity-backed growth strategy that leans on acquisitions.

In the last two quarters the company closed two regional acquisitions and began consolidating dispatch operations onto a single team. Management has repeatedly framed on-time performance as the metric that decides contract renewals.

Snapshot	
BUSINESS	Asset-light 3PL: truckload brokerage plus dedicated fleet contracts and regional last-mile.
CUSTOMERS	Mid-market retailers, building-products distributors, and two national grocery co-packers.
PRIORITIES	- Cut late-delivery penalties on dedicated-fleet contracts - Integrate the two acquired regional operations onto one dispatch process - Grow dedicated-fleet share of revenue

What changed lately

Date	Change
Aug 2026	Hired a new Chief Information Security Officer. [SOURCED] [S3]
Jul 2026	Closed acquisition of a Midwest regional carrier; dispatch teams merging. [SOURCED] [S2]
Jun 2026	Opened 6 roles for dispatch planners and one for a Director of Network Planning. [SOURCED] [S4]

02 Pain from earnings calls

Problems leadership has already admitted in public.

Challenge 1	
CHALLENGE	Late-delivery penalties are eroding margin on dedicated-fleet contracts. [SOURCED] [S1]
THEIR WORDS	“Service failures cost us more than fuel this quarter.” CFO - Q2 2026 earnings call
WHERE WE FIT	RoutelQ re-plans dispatch continuously against live ETAs, which targets the late-arrival root cause.

Challenge 2	
CHALLENGE	Integrating acquired operations onto a single dispatch process is slower than planned. [SOURCED] [S1]
THEIR WORDS	“We are still running three dispatch playbooks across the network.” COO - Q2 2026 earnings call
WHERE WE FIT	One optimization layer across depots without forcing each team to change TMS first.

Challenge 3	
CHALLENGE	Driver capacity is tight, and empty miles are climbing. [INFERRED] [S1]
THEIR WORDS	"Empty-mile percentage rose again as we absorbed the new lanes." CEO - Q2 2026 earnings call
WHERE WE FIT	Backhaul matching and load balancing reduce deadhead. Confirm current empty-mile baseline in discovery.

03 Your contact's role

What a VP of Operations cares about right now.

Role read	
CONTACT	Dana Whitfield, VP of Operations
CARES ABOUT	- Getting three dispatch teams onto one repeatable process - On-time performance she can report upward each week - Hiring and retaining dispatch planners (six open roles)

Evidence behind the read

Signal
Company announcement names her as lead for the dispatch consolidation. [SOURCED] [S2]
Six open dispatch-planner roles on her team suggest capacity strain. [INFERRED] [S4]
GAP - Note. LinkedIn profile is gated. Paste her recent posts if you want the opener personalized further.

B

Shape the conversation

Turn research into words you will actually say.

04 Discovery questions

Open questions surface stories; yes/no questions surface politeness.

Q1	
ASK	Walk me through what happens today when a load is going to miss its window.
FOLLOW-UP	Who finds out first, and how long until a decision is made?
WHY THIS	Surfaces the penalty pain named on the Q2 call.
Q2	
ASK	How are the merged regions dispatching differently right now?
FOLLOW-UP	Which of those differences would you keep if you could?
WHY THIS	Tests the integration-slower-than-planned admission.

Q3	
ASK	What does a great week look like for your dispatch team, and what usually gets in the way?
FOLLOW-UP	How do you measure that today?
WHY THIS	Reveals success metrics and reporting pressure.
Q4	
ASK	Tell me about the last time you evaluated a tool for planning or dispatch.
FOLLOW-UP	What made it stall or succeed?
WHY THIS	Finds buying history, blockers, and the incumbent.
Q5	
ASK	Who else would need to be comfortable before a change to dispatch tooling goes live?
FOLLOW-UP	What would their first question be?
WHY THIS	Maps the committee and the likely security review.

05 A specific opener

Answers 'why should I care' in two sentences.

Dana, I saw Harborline closed the Midwest carrier deal in July and is folding dispatch onto one team. That usually makes late-window recovery the first thing to crack, and it is exactly where we help ops leaders get a single view.

Anchored on: Acquisition announcement and dispatch consolidation [S2]

C

Map the deal

Prepare for the room, not just the person.

06 Buying committee

Decision-makers, influencers, blockers.

Role	Person	Type	How they will judge us
Economic buyer	CFO (name on Q2 call) Verified	Decision-maker	Penalty reduction and payback period in under 12 months.
Operations lead	Dana Whitfield, VP Operations Verified	Champion candidate	Adoption by dispatchers and one standard process.
Security	New CISO (hired Aug 2026) Unverified	Blocker risk	Data access, SOC 2, and integration footprint.
IT / TMS owner	Not identified Unverified	Influencer	Integration effort with the current TMS.

07 Likely objections

Prepared sellers stay calm and hold price.

Objection 1: We are mid-integration and cannot absorb another project. [INFERRED]	
RESPONSE	Position a two-depot pilot that runs beside existing dispatch and gives the consolidation team live data rather than another workstream.
BASIS	Integration timing from S2.
Objection 2: We already have a TMS with routing. [INFERRED]	
RESPONSE	Agree, then ask where late-window recovery happens today. RouteIQ layers on top and does not replace the TMS.
BASIS	Typical 3PL stack. Confirm TMS vendor in discovery.
Objection 3: Security review will take months. [SOURCED]	
RESPONSE	Offer the security pack up front and ask to include the CISO in call two.
BASIS	New CISO hire (S3).

08 Competitor landscape

Know the gaps before the buyer points them out.

Competitor	Positioning	Pricing	Gaps / where we win
FleetWise [SOURCED]	Broad fleet management suite with a routing module, sold to mid-market carriers.	Per-vehicle subscription; exact numbers not public.	Weaker multi-depot balancing; routing is batch, not live re-planning. [S5]
Status quo (spreadsheets plus TMS) [INFERRED]	Dispatchers re-plan manually in the TMS.	No license cost; hidden cost in planner hours.	Three playbooks across regions, which is the pain named on the Q2 call. [S1]

09 Objections battle card

The five pushbacks most likely to come up, with the concern behind each.

1. Your price is higher than what we pay today.	
REAL CONCERN	Fear of a cost line that cannot be tied to penalties saved.
MY RESPONSE	Frame against penalty dollars, not license cost, then size the penalty base together.
PROOF POINT	Fictional case: a 30-depot 3PL cut late penalties 22% in two quarters.
ASK BACK	What did late penalties cost you last quarter?

2. We do not have time for a rollout right now.

REAL CONCERN	Integration fatigue after two acquisitions.
MY RESPONSE	Pilot on two depots, no TMS change, 30-day read-out.
PROOF POINT	Fictional case: pilot live in 12 business days.
ASK BACK	Which two depots are the noisiest today?

3. We need IT and security to look at this first.

REAL CONCERN	New CISO wants control of vendor access.
MY RESPONSE	Send the security pack today and invite them to the next call.
PROOF POINT	SOC 2 Type II report available (confirm status before saying this).
ASK BACK	Who owns vendor security review, and what does their process look like?

4. How is this different from FleetWise?

REAL CONCERN	Wants to avoid a second evaluation cycle.
MY RESPONSE	Live re-planning across depots versus batch routing per vehicle.
PROOF POINT	Side-by-side on a real lane set in the pilot.
ASK BACK	Which capabilities in that evaluation mattered most?

5. Our dispatchers will not adopt it.

REAL CONCERN	Six open planner roles, change fatigue.
MY RESPONSE	Recommendations, not auto-dispatch; planners approve every change.
PROOF POINT	Fictional: 85% planner acceptance rate in pilot.
ASK BACK	What would make a planner trust a recommendation on day one?

Practice it: load this battle card into your role-play tool of choice and run the five objections out loud before the call.

D

Follow through

Where most deals are won or quietly lost.

10 Custom follow-up plan

One email, three useful touchpoints. Drafts only - review before sending.

SUBJECT

Late-window recovery across your merged depots

Hi Dana,

Thanks for the time today. You described three dispatch playbooks running side by side, and the Q2 call put late-delivery penalties at the top of the margin story.

As discussed, I will send the two-depot pilot outline and our security pack by Friday so your security team can review in parallel.

Would a 20-minute call next week with whoever owns vendor security work?

Best,
Alex

Value-adding touches

When	Channel	Touch	Tied to
Day 2	Email	Two-page pilot outline sized to two depots, plus the security pack.	Integration fatigue
Day 7	LinkedIn	Share a short piece on late-window recovery benchmarks for 3PLs.	Penalty pain
Day 14	Call	Invite the CISO to a 20-minute security walkthrough.	Security review

Gaps and asks

Anything that could not be verified is listed here instead of being guessed. Paste the item and the affected stage can be re-run.

Stage	What is missing	What to paste or confirm
3	LinkedIn profile for Dana Whitfield is login-gated.	Paste her last 3 posts or headline.
6	CISO name and TMS owner not publicly verified.	Confirm names from your CRM.
8	FleetWise pricing is not public.	Paste any lost-deal notes with competitor pricing.
9	Real customer proof points and SOC 2 status.	Paste approved case studies and security status.

Sources

ID	Source	Accessed
S1	Harborline Logistics Q2 2026 earnings call transcript (fictional) https://investors.harborline-logistics.example/q2-2026	2026-09-29
S2	Press release: Harborline completes Midwest carrier acquisition (fictional) https://harborline-logistics.example/news/acquisition	2026-09-29
S3	Press release: Harborline names Chief Information Security Officer (fictional) https://harborline-logistics.example/news/ciso	2026-09-29
S4	Harborline careers page, dispatch roles (fictional) https://harborline-logistics.example/careers	2026-09-29
S5	FleetWise product page (fictional) https://fleetwise.example/routing	2026-09-29